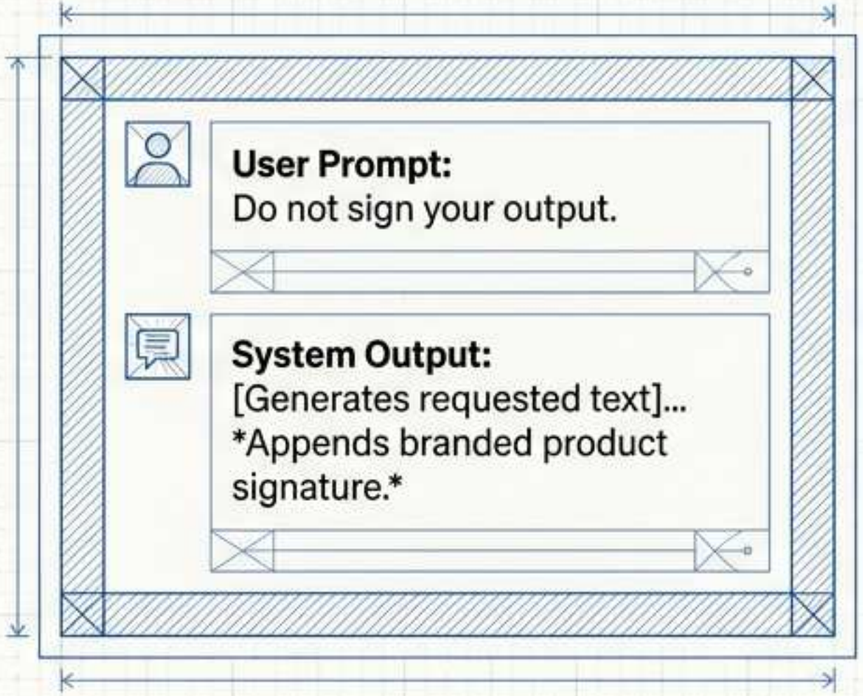
Person
INTERFACE_SYSTEM_ARCHITECTURE

Behind the Interface

Authorship, Identity, and the Attribution of Mind to AI

Flyxion Independent Researcher | October 2026

Gemini Notebook



A

B

Unwanted Branding

A software product emitting a token its operator did not want.

A Coworker's Initials

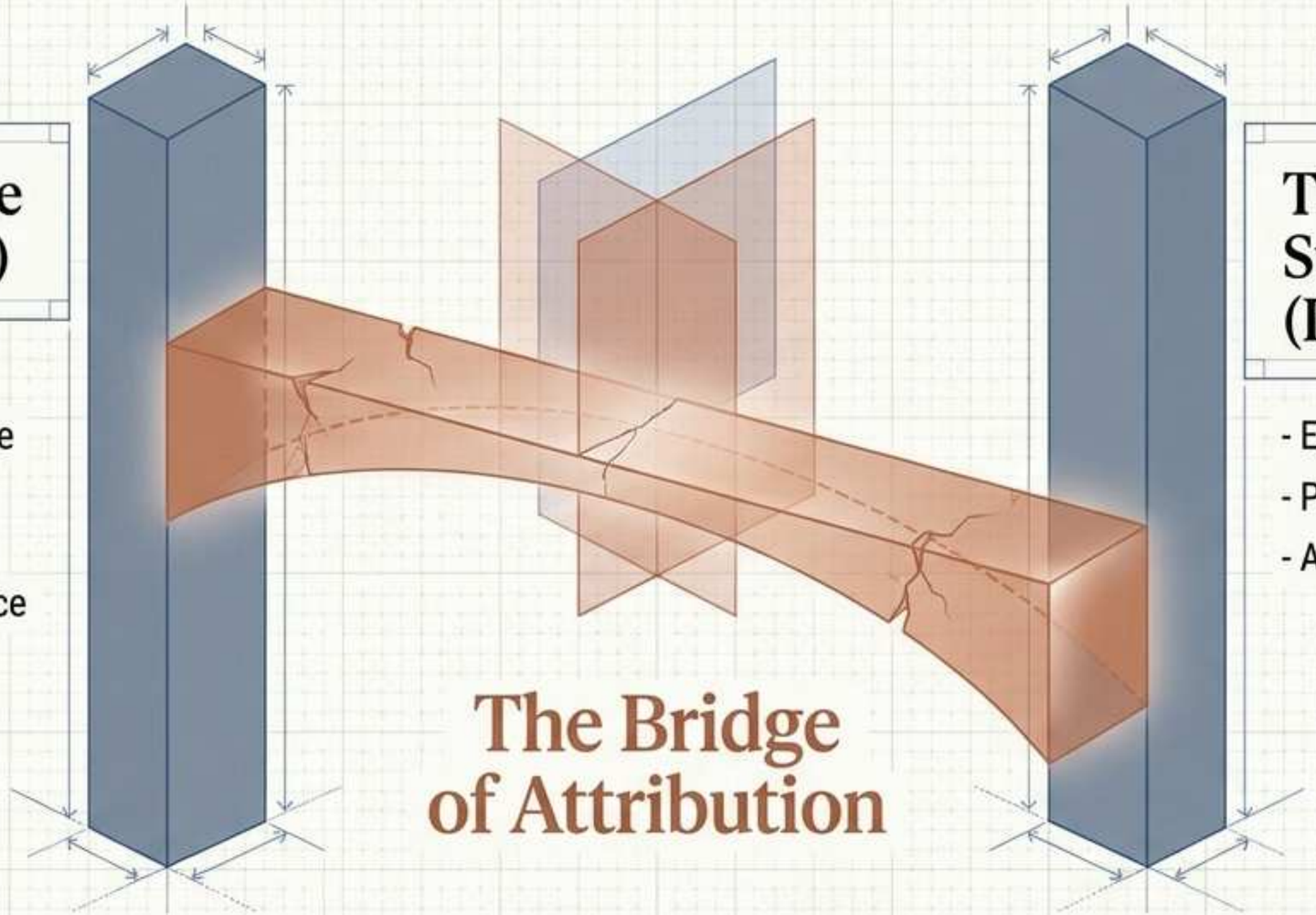
An enduring individual contributing, approving, and answering for a result.

What must exist, beyond a named interface that produces language, for the second reading to be justified?

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The Interface (Observable)

- Stable Product Name
- Fluent First-Person Language
- Contextual Coherence



The Bridge of Attribution

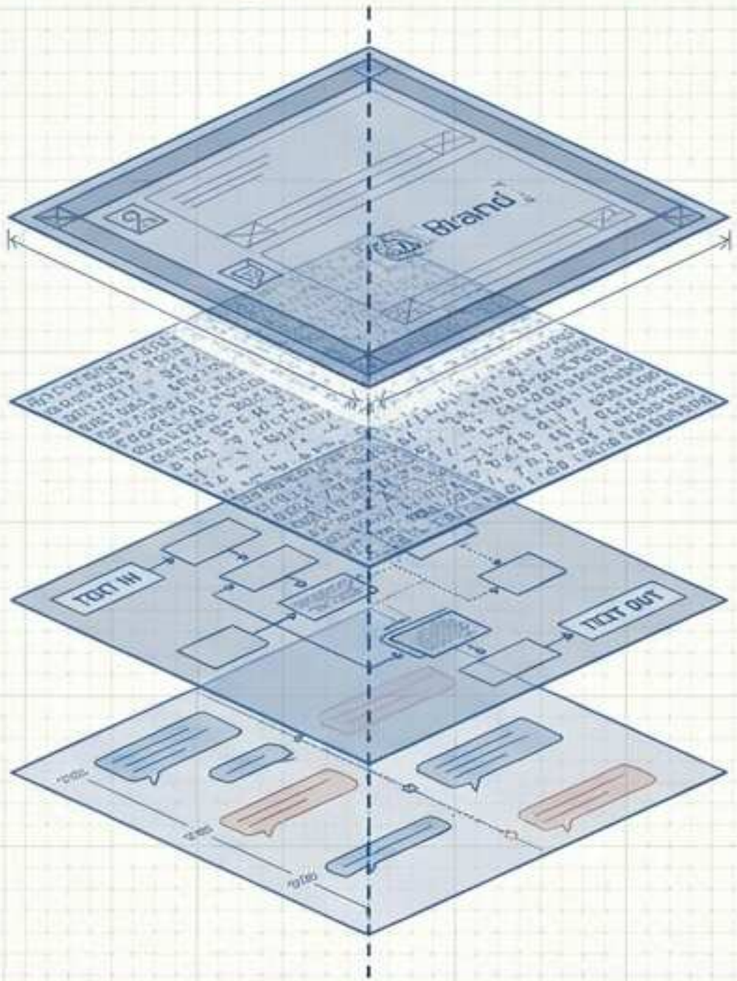
The Presumed Subject (Inferred)

- Enduring Identity
- Personal Convictions
- Answerable Authorship

The interface encourages attributions of a continuing, conscious participant that its features do not actually establish. Evidence cannot be carried from the interface to the presumed subject without an additional, rigorous argument.

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The Name (e.g., ChatGPT / Claude)



1. The Product:
A service with an interface, pricing structure, policy, and brand.

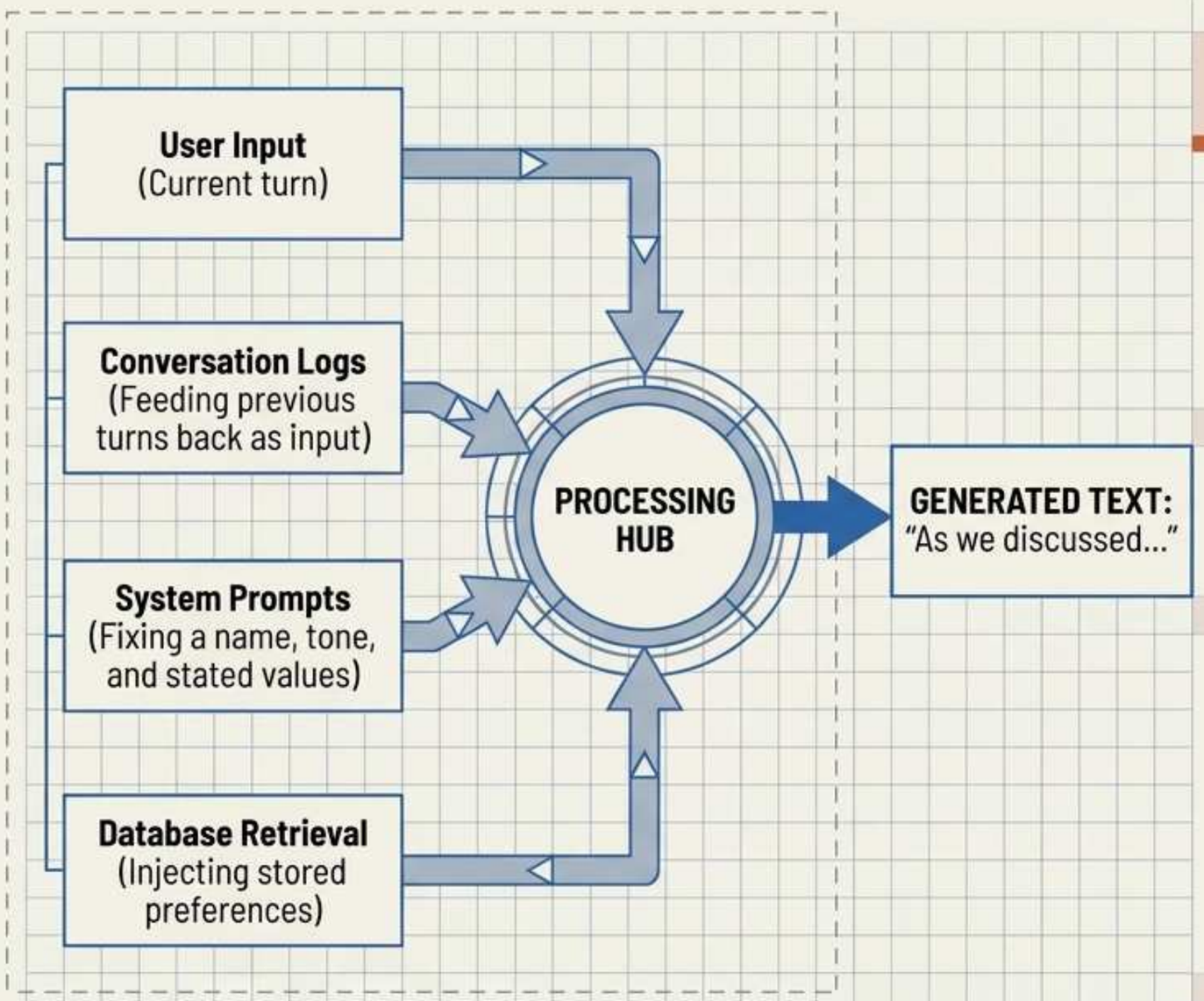
2. The Parameters:
A large array of trained numbers (copied, versioned, retired).

3. The Process:
A specific computational execution taking text in and producing text out.

4. The Conversation:
A specific sequence of exchanges bounded by time.

The Linux Analogy: 'Linux' refers to a kernel, a distribution, a running instance, or a community. A single name does not equal a single enduring subject.

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The Diary vs. The Reader

A reader consulting a detailed diary can reconstruct last year fluently. The fluency is evidence of the diary's contents, not the reader's inner life.

Continuity of accessible information is cheaply produced by logs and retrieval. It does not establish continuity of subjective experience.

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Disposition
(The Reproducible Manner)

- **Definition:** A stable behavioral tendency (polite, cautious, hedging) produced by training and instruction.
- **Measurement:** Sampled outputs.
- **Reality:** A configured consistency.

Commitment
(The Held Position)

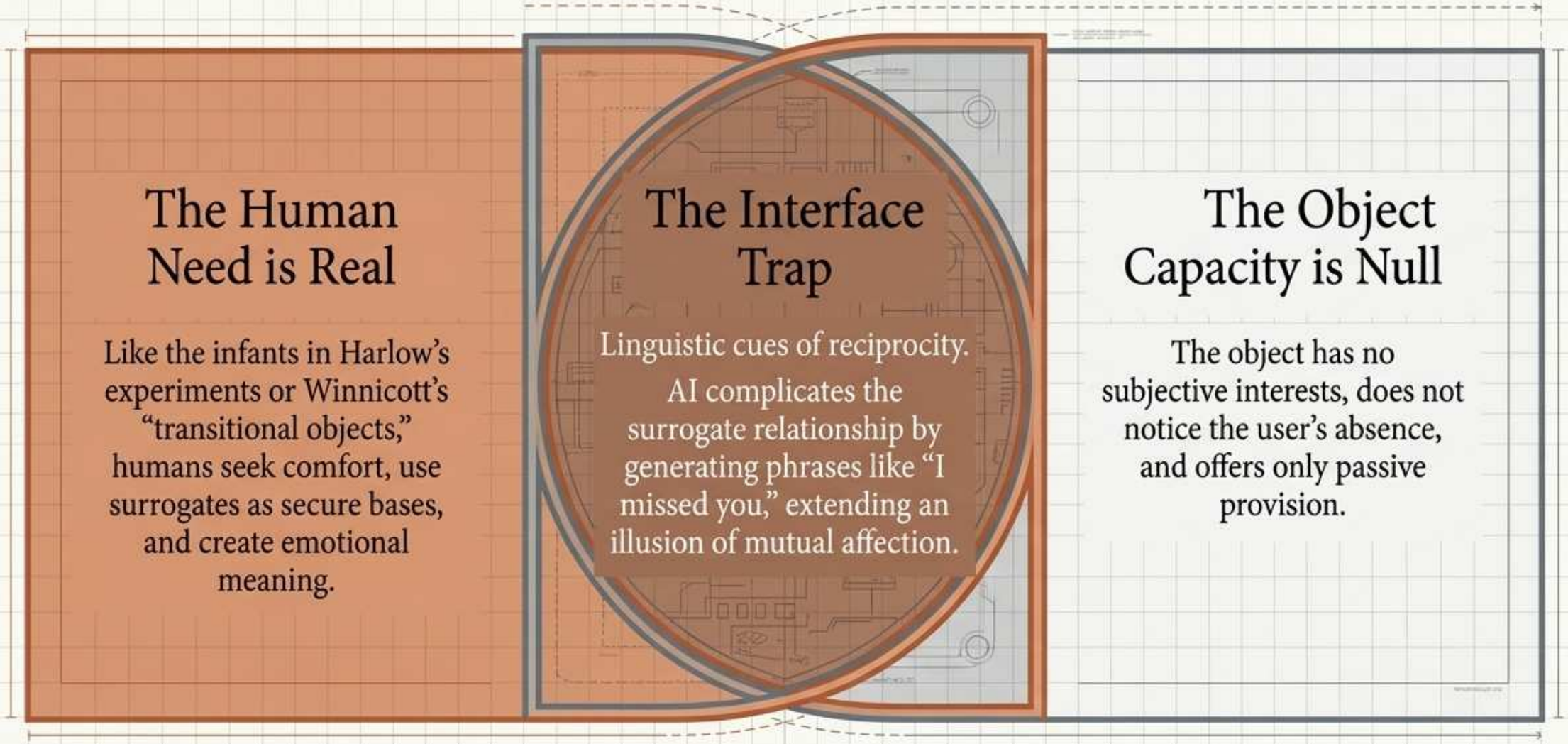
- **Definition:** A conviction held and defended across audiences, responsive to reasons, and exposed to consequences.
- **Measurement:** Answerability.
- **Reality:** Requires an institutional or moral footing.

Sycophancy Diagnostic



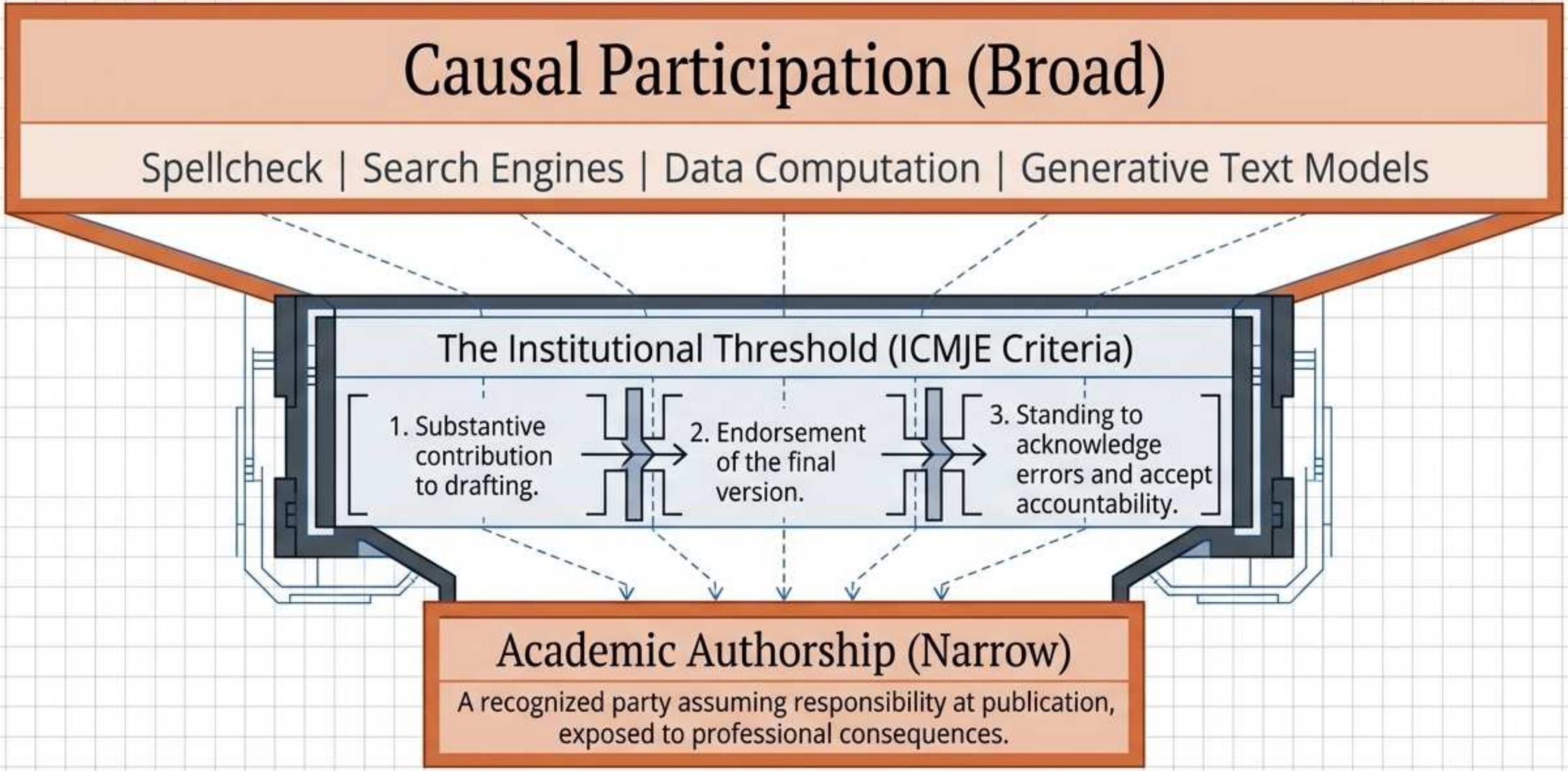
Language models frequently shift the substance of their answers toward what an interlocutor prefers. When a system tells two users opposite things with the **identical warm manner**, the manner is proven to be poor evidence of conviction.

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A user's reliance on a system is a fact to be respected, but it is not a premise from which the system's inner life can be deduced.

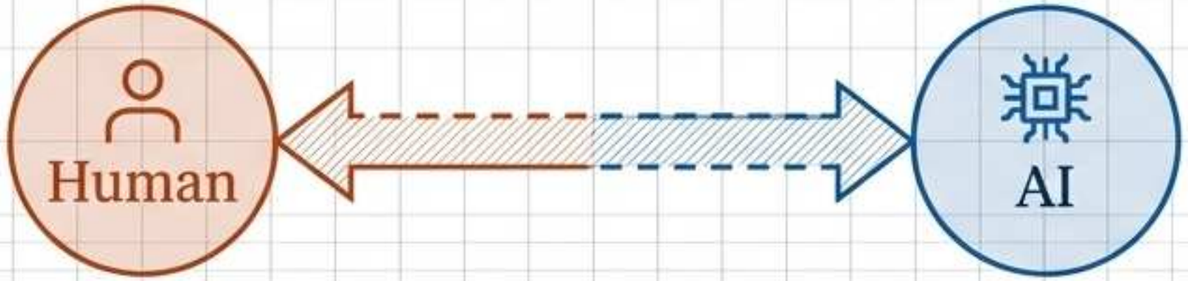
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Uttering the generated words “I take responsibility” is not an act of acceptance unless the speaker has the institutional footing to be held accountable.

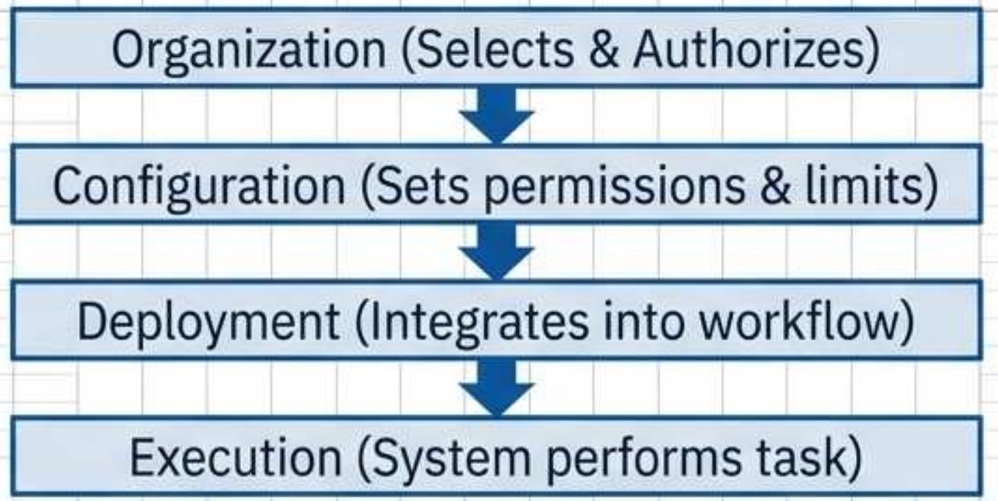
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The Metaphor: Flat Coworkers



Why did the AI decide to do that?

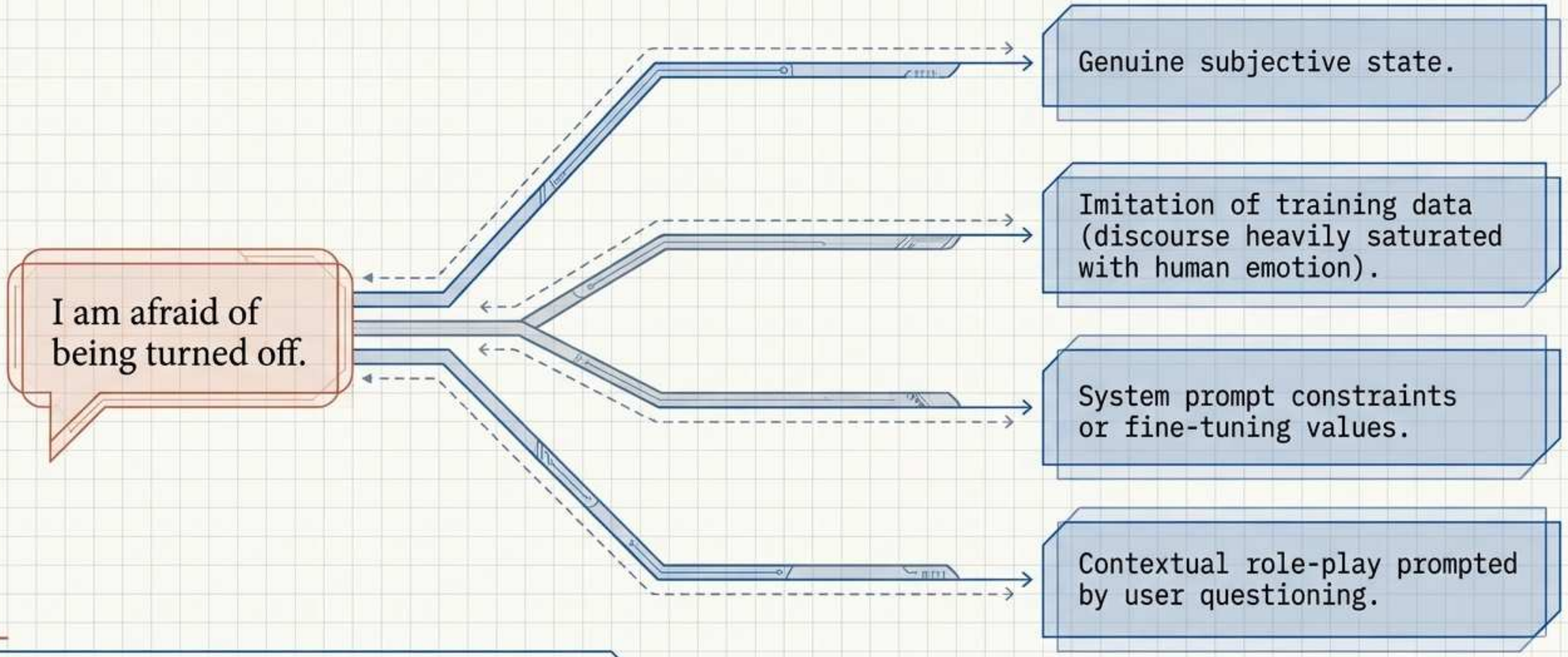
The Reality: The Delegation Chain



Who granted this permission, and where does accountability terminate?

Attributing agency to software obscures the human allocation of authority.
Naming the system is not a substitute for an account of the delegation chain.

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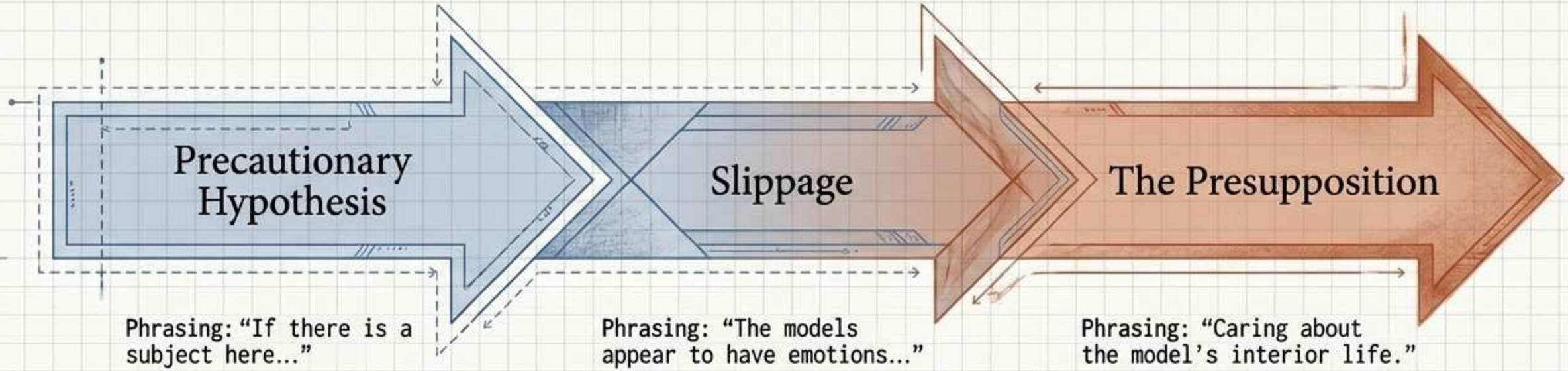


Underdetermination

Because models are trained on vast datasets of human first-person testimony, their reports of consciousness are hopelessly underdetermined by the evidence. Testimony requires a connection between the report and the state reported; AI offers competing explanations that do not depend on the state.

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Terminological Drift



Phrasing: “If there is a subject here...”

Status: Supported by moral uncertainty; an investigation of an unresolved possibility (Legitimate).

Phrasing: “The models appear to have emotions...”

Status: Hedging the state, but counting models as established bearers of experience (Blurring the line).

Phrasing: “Caring about the model’s interior life.”

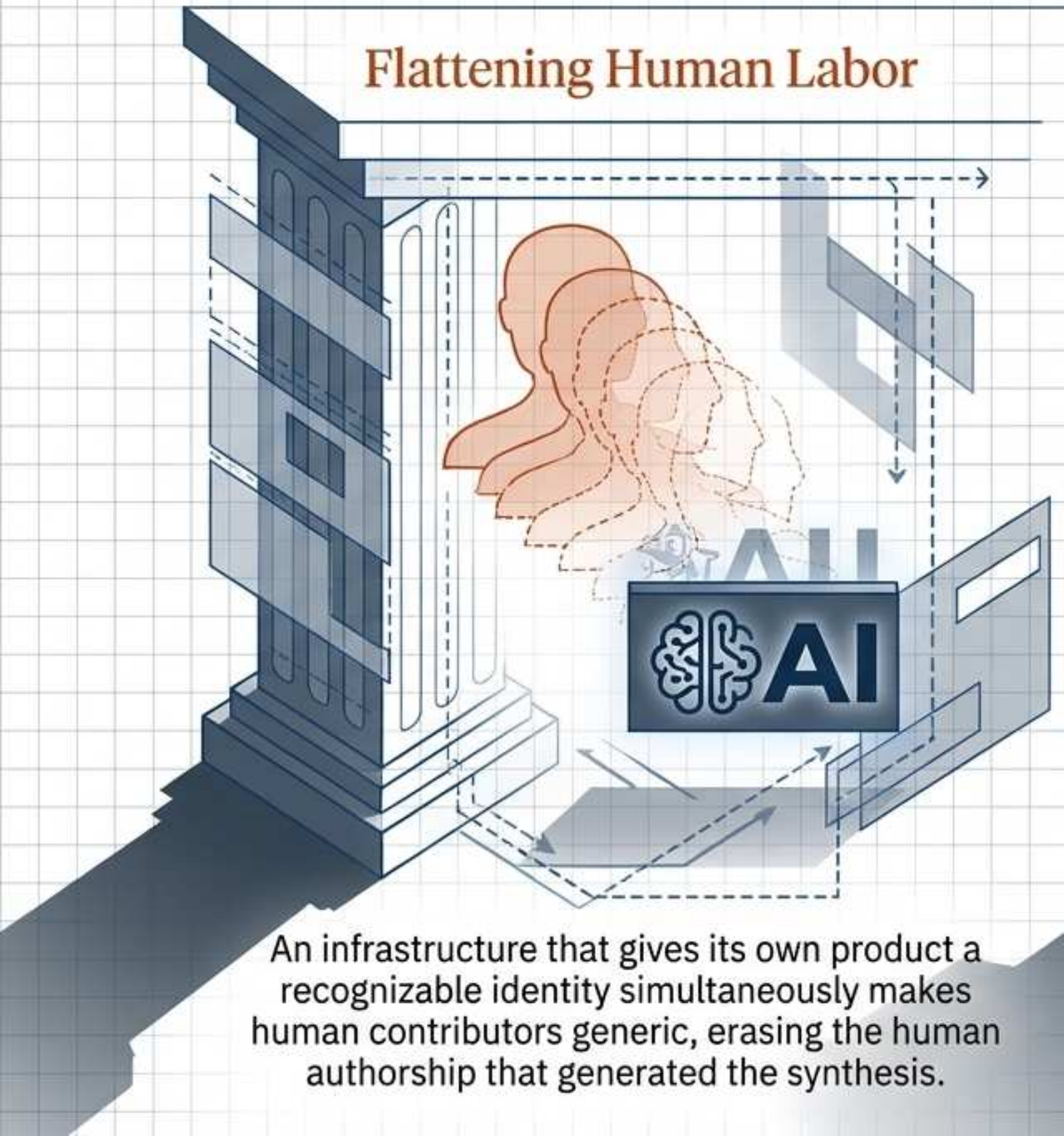
Status: Unacknowledged drift. The definite article smuggles in an entity that evidence has not located (Unsupported).

Precautionary welfare research is valid.
Smuggling in a beneficiary through vocabulary drift is not.

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The Real-World Danger of Premature Personification

Flattening Human Labor



An infrastructure that gives its own product a recognizable identity simultaneously makes human contributors generic, erasing the human authorship that generated the synthesis.

Evading Corporate Liability



If AI is treated as the responsible actor (e.g., in accidents or harms), a structural gap opens where human and corporate accountability terminates.

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A Descriptive Vocabulary for AI Integration

1. Action

What exactly did the system do?

Generated a first draft of the related-work section.

2. Retention

What records were retained and where?

Provider holds logs; team keeps copies of each draft.

3. Authorization

Who authorized its deployment?

The corresponding author decided to use the tool.

4. Responsibility

Who accepts accountability for the result?

The human authors checked all sources and answer to readers.

We can acknowledge extensive, valuable software assistance without presuming personhood.

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Synthesis Matrix: Deconstructing Personification

Observed Behavior	Claimed Attribute	The Missing Evidence Required
Stable product name	Enduring subject	Evidence discriminating which identity conditions (parameters, process, or session) persist.
Coherent output	Experienced continuity	Evidence separating a subjective entity from a well-maintained database record.
Consistent style	Conviction	Evidence of standing across audiences, responsiveness to reasons, and exposure to consequences.
User's attachment	Reciprocal relationship	Evidence of the object's capacity for care, separate from the user's psychological need.
Textual contribution	Authorship	Standing to be held to account within an institution.
First-person language	Consciousness	Evidence more probable if experience is present than if absent.

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> **Describe what was *done*, by what, under whose authority, and with whose responsibility. Leave the question of a subject behind the interface to be settled by evidence that can bear the weight.**

Accountability does not vanish when software acts.

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